2026 Lions Pass Game v1

09.10.2025

GENERAL RULES - PASS GAME

Numbering Receivers:

- Receivers are numbered from **outside to inside** on each side of the formation
- **#1 = Wide receiver** (outermost receiver on each side)
- **#2 = Slot receiver** (inside of #1)
- **#3 = Inside slot** (in 3x1 formations, the innermost receiver)
- **In stacked formations:** The receiver on the Line of Scrimmage (LOS) is treated as if they are **outside** the receiver behind them for numbering purposes

  Example of Stack numbering:

  - If T is on LOS and A is stacked behind T, T is #1 and A is #2

Field vs Boundary:

- **Field = Wide side of the field** (more space)
- **Boundary = Short side of the field** (less space)
- **Right Hash:** Field is LEFT side, Boundary is RIGHT side
- **Left Hash:** Field is RIGHT side, Boundary is LEFT side
- **Middle Hash:** <u>SAME AS RIGHT HASH</u>

Progression System:

- **ALERT** = Pre-snap read - if you like the matchup, take it immediately. **QB** can throw the route without Alert, **Receivers** need to expect the ball early if it's called
- **1, 2, 3, 4** = Numbered progression reads
- **CD** = Checkdown (last resort/safety valve)

Hash Adjustments:

- **All diagrams shown from RIGHT HASH perspective**
- **On LEFT HASH:** Mirror everything to opposite side
- Field/boundary rules stay the same, formations flip

PASS PROTECTION RULES v1

!!Notes: Full-Ray, Full-Lou will be used after scrimmage. If we can, we will add pass pro audibles in future.

1. CUP (Big-On-Big)

Rules:

- Each offensive lineman blocks the defender aligned over or closest to them
- "Big-On-Big" - linemen take defensive linemen, leave linebackers for skill players
- RB is responsible for first free rusher (usually Mike or blitzing linebacker)
- If RB has a route, QB should throw to hot routes.

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2. RAY (Half-Slide Right)

Rules:

- Offensive line: Right side slides protection to the RIGHT, Left side Big-on-Big
- RB checks LEFT side (backside) for edge rusher
- **QB IS RESPONSIBLE FOR LEFT SIDE LINEBACKERS!** We always call half-slide to the non-concept side. If the defense blitz from the side you are reading, it's YOUR responsibility to take hot routes.

Assignments:

- **LT:** Big-on-Big
- **LG:** Big-on-Big
- **C, RG, RT:** Protect your right side GAP, take inside-out rushers
- **RB:** If you don't have route; Check backside (LEFT), If we have free rusher block him, If we don't help backside

3. LOU (Half-Slide Left)

Rules:

- Offensive line: Left side slides protection to the LEFT, Right side Big-on-Big
- RB checks RIGHT side (backside) for edge rusher
- **QB IS RESPONSIBLE FOR RIGHT SIDE LINEBACKERS!** We always call half-slide to the non-concept side. If the defense blitz from the side you are reading, it's YOUR responsibility to take hot routes.

Assignments:

- **RT:** Big-on-Big
- **RG:** Big-on-Big
- **C, LG, LT:** Protect your left side GAP, take inside-out rushers
- **RB:** If you don't have route; Check backside (LEFT), If we have free rusher block him, If we don't help backside

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4. FULL RAY Protection (Full Slide Right)

Rules:

- Entire offensive line slides protection to the RIGHT as one unit
- RB stays IN protection on the LEFT side
- All five linemen work together, no man-to-man assignments

Assignments:

- **All 5 OL:** Slide RIGHT together, inside-out technique, pass off rushers
- **RB:** Stay IN protection, block backside (LEFT) edge rusher or first threat

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5. FULL LOU Protection (Full Slide Left)

Rules:

- Entire offensive line slides protection to the LEFT as one unit
- RB stays IN protection on the RIGHT side
- All five linemen work together, no man-to-man assignments

Assignments:

- **All 5 OL:** Slide LEFT together, inside-out technique, pass off rushers
- **RB:** Stay IN protection, block backside (RIGHT) edge rusher or first threat

6. BOOT RIGHT Protection

Rules:

- Offensive line runs **Outside Zone blocking LEFT** (opposite of boot direction)
- **DO NOT climb to second level** - stay on defensive line
- Simulate run blocking to freeze linebackers
- QB boots RIGHT with play-action fake

Assignments:

- **All 5 OL:** Outside zone blocking LEFT, reach and seal defensive linemen, DO NOT climb to LBs
- **RB:** Fake run LEFT (opposite QB boot), then can release or stay for extra protection
- **QB:** Play-action fake, boot RIGHT outside the pocket

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7. BOOT LEFT Protection

Rules:

- Offensive line runs **Outside Zone blocking RIGHT** (opposite of boot direction)
- **DO NOT climb to second level** - stay on defensive line
- Simulate run blocking to freeze linebackers
- QB boots LEFT with play-action fake

Assignments:

- **All 5 OL:** Outside zone blocking RIGHT, reach and seal defensive linemen, DO NOT climb to LBs
- **RB:** Fake run RIGHT (opposite QB boot), then can release or stay for extra protection
- **QB:** Play-action fake, boot LEFT outside the pocket

QUICK GAME

STICK

Rules: Stick concept on Field, Dig and 5-out/Flat on Boundary.

2x2 Formation:

- **Field Side (wide side of field):**
  - #1: GO — Must outside release, vertical stem, clear Flat zone
  - #2: STICK — 5 yards, plant hard, sit in grass vs zone / work away from LB
  - 2-back: FLAT to field side — 2-3 yard depth, horizontal stretch
- **Boundary (short side):**
  - #1: DIG — 10-12 yard in-breaking route, find grass in middle
  - #2: 5-OUT — 5 yard out-breaking route, checkdown
- **QB Progression:** ALERT(X's go if pre-snap) → 1 (Stick) → 2 (Flat) → 3 (Dig) → CD (5-out)

3x1 Formation:

- **Field Side (wide side of field):**
  - #1: GO — Must outside release, vertical stem, clear Flat zone
  - #2: 5-YARD QUICK OUT — Gain 5-yard depth, make a speed cut
  - #3 Receiver: STICK — 5 yards, sit in grass. If LB covers you take the out option
- **Boundary (short side):**
  - #1: DIG — 10-12 yard in-breaking route, find grass in middle
  - 2-back**:** FLAT to boundary — 2-3 yard depth, horizontal stretch
- **QB Progression:** ALERT (X's go if pre-snap) → 1 (Quick out) → 2 (Stick) → 3 (Dig) → CD (Flat)

Tag Options:

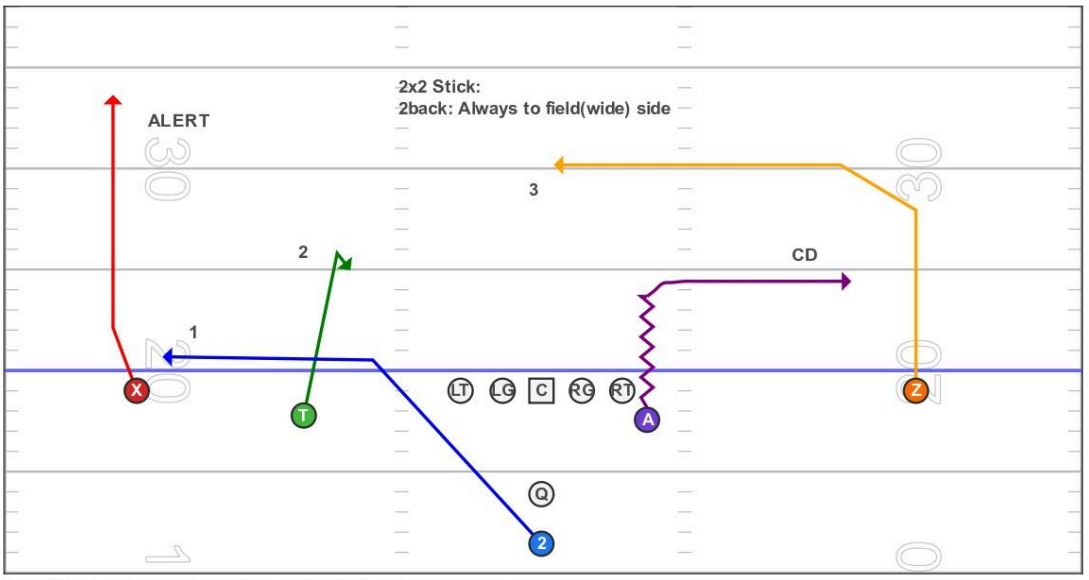
STICK FADE: Changing responsibilities between Wide out and Slot receiver on concept side.

- #1: 5-YARD HITCH — Sell vertical, attack where 5-out should be
- #2: SLOT FADE — Win outside, attack over CB

Key Coaching Points:

- Stick runner must stem vertical first 3 steps to sell the go route, then plant hard at 5 yards
- Don't drift on the stick — be a stationary target for the QB
- RB on flat: aim for 2-3 yards deep, give QB an outlet vs pressure

"2026 LUZERN STICK



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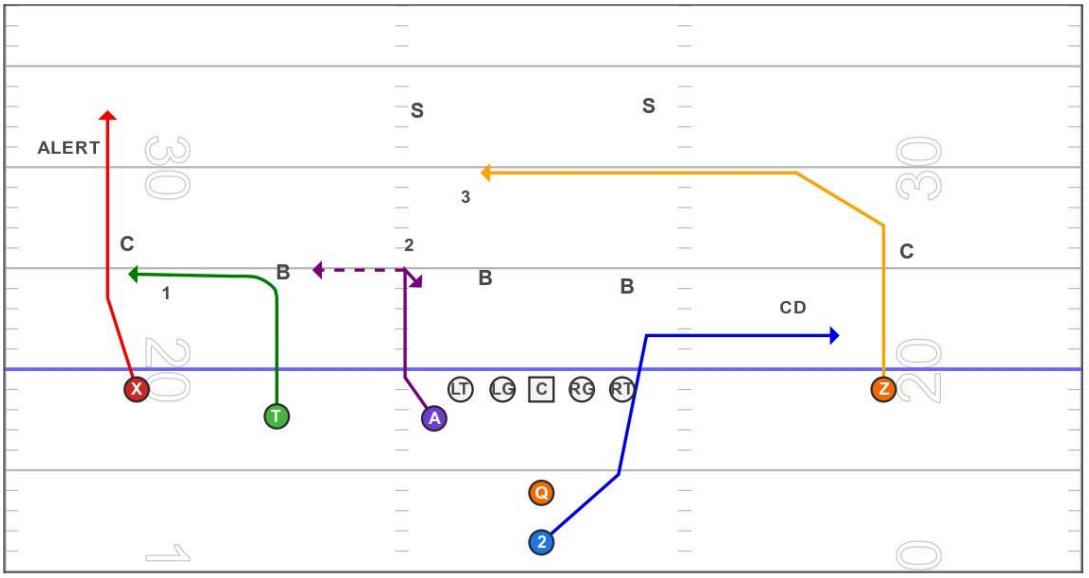

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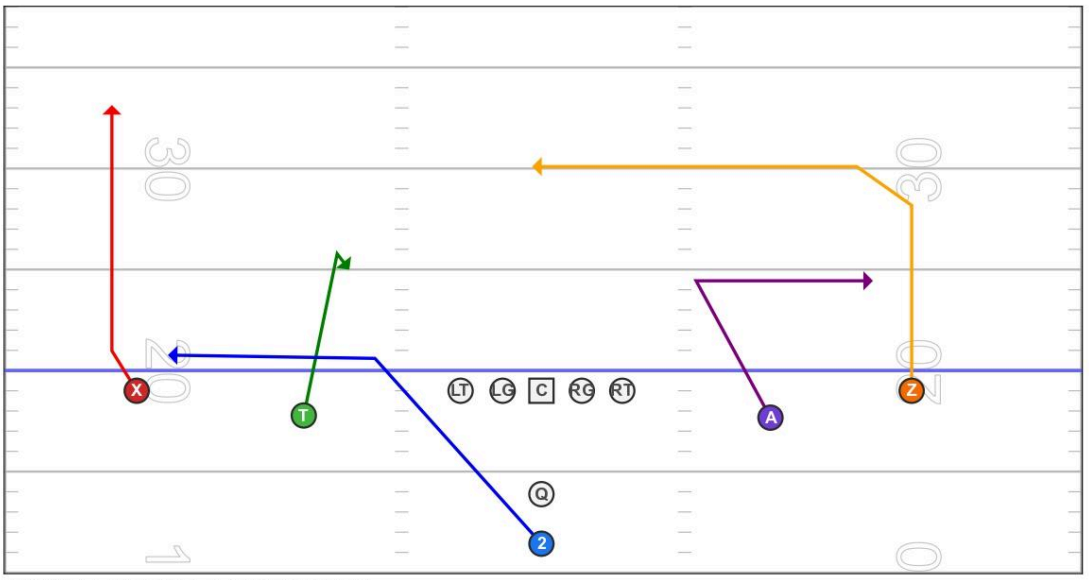

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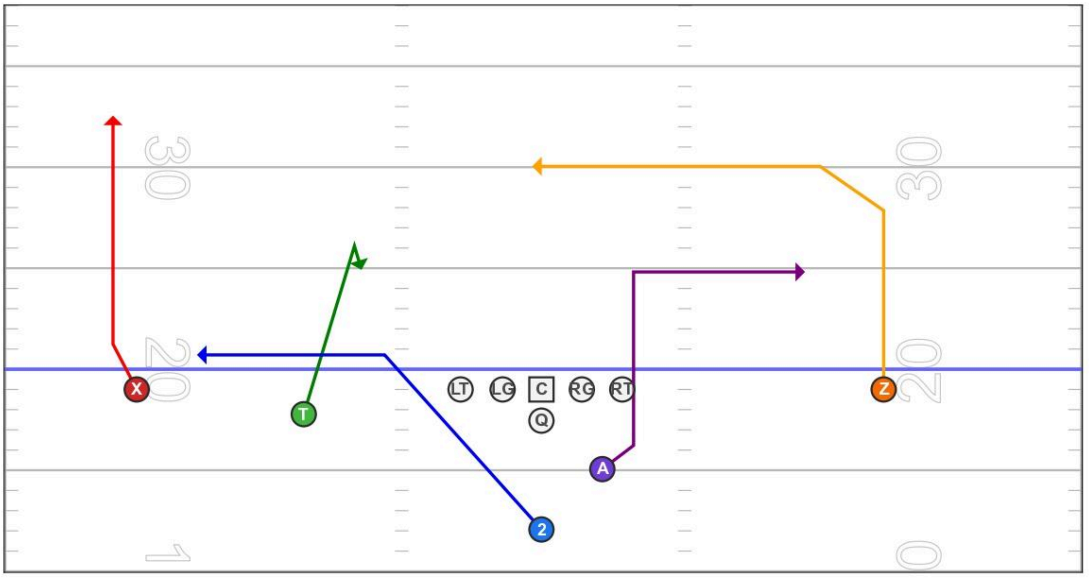

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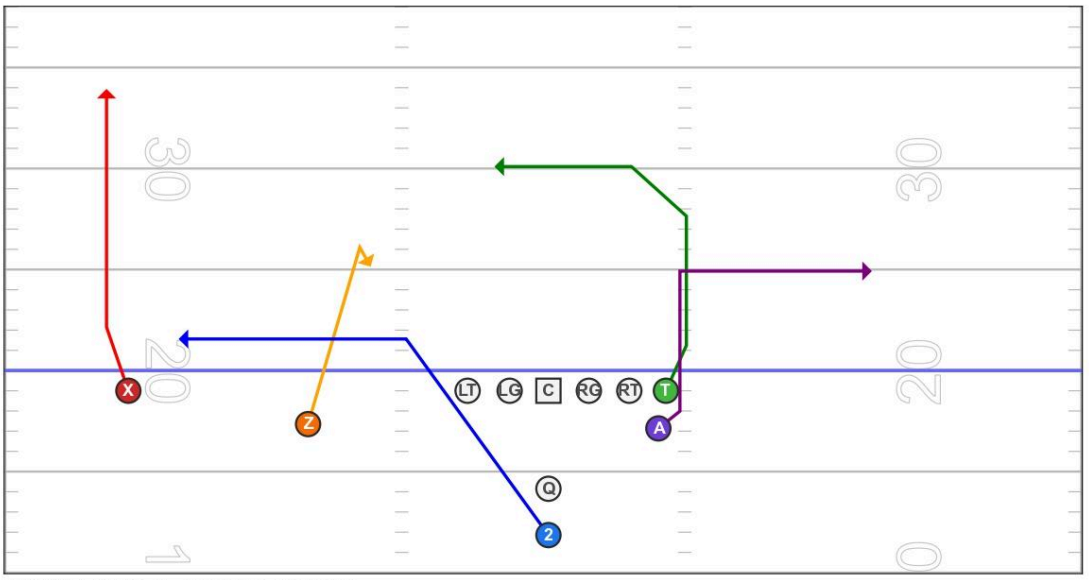

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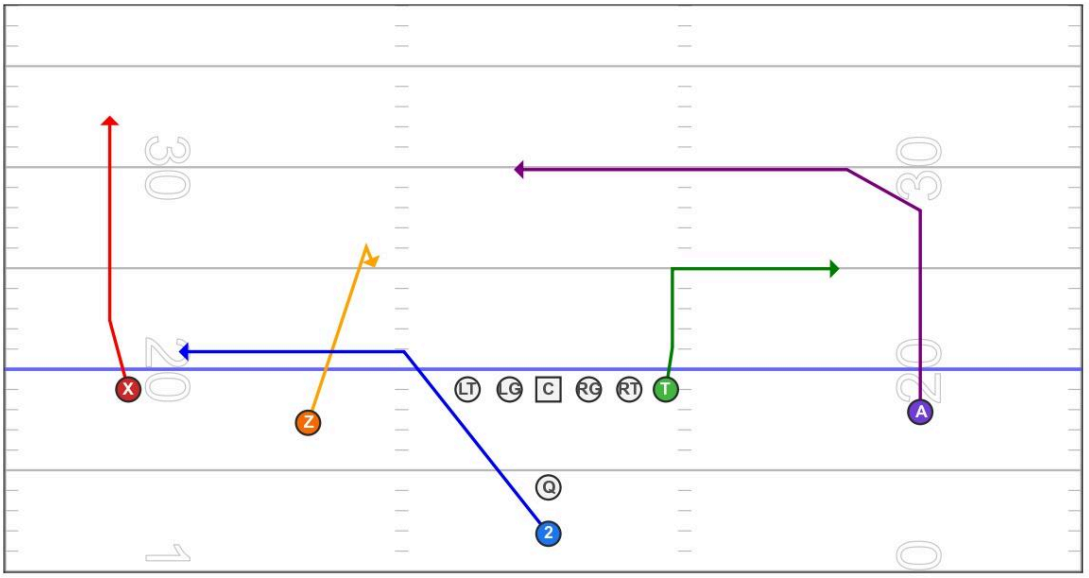

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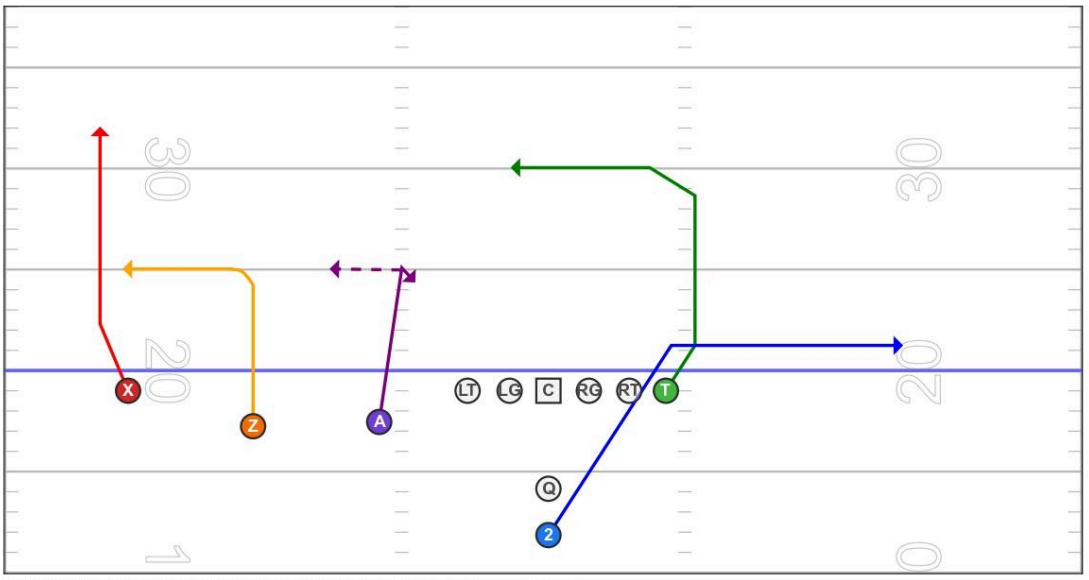

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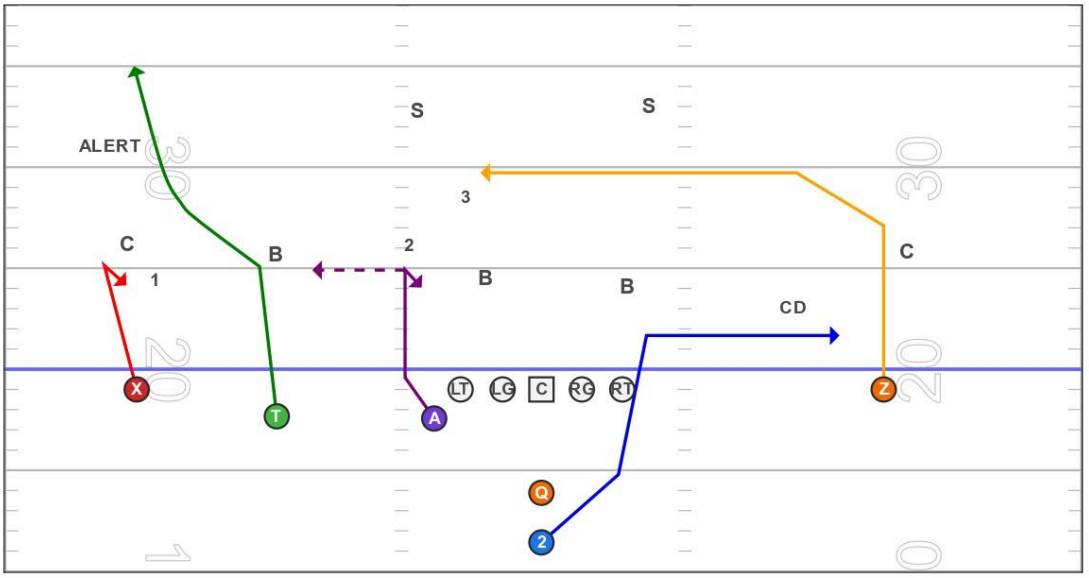


SPACING

Rules: Double slants on field side, spacing concept on boundary. **2x2 Formation only.**

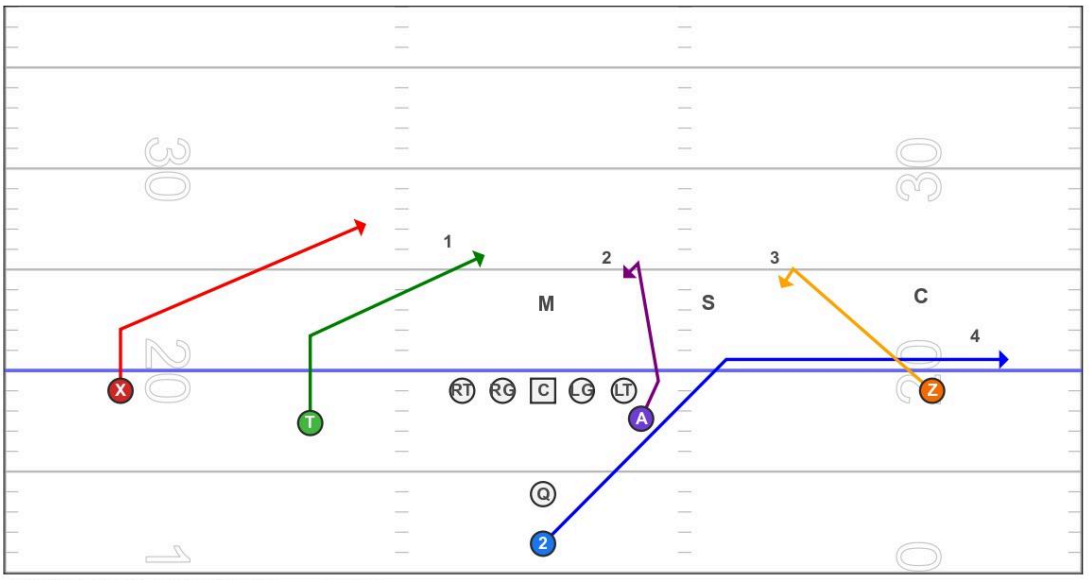
2x2 Formation:

- **Field Side (wide side of field):**
  - #1: 3-STEP SLANT — Win inside, attack inside leverage
  - #2: 1-STEP SLANT — Quick inside break, expect ball before MLB
- **Boundary (short side):**
  - #1: 5-YARD SIT — Sit outside shoulder of outside linebacker, find grass
  - #2: 5-YARD SIT — Sit inside shoulder of outside linebacker, find space before MLB
  - 2-back: FLAT to boundary — 2-3 yard depth, horizontal stretch
- **!!! EXCEPTION ON ZUG:**
  - #1: 5-YARD SIT — Sit **INSIDE** shoulder of outside linebacker, find space before MLB
  - #2: 5-YARD SIT — Sit **OUTSIDE** shoulder of outside linebacker, find grass
- **QB Progression:** ALERT (Field wide slant if pre-snap) → 1 (Field slot slant) → 2 (Boundary inside hitch) → 3 (Boundary outside hitch) → 4 (RB flat)

Key Coaching Points:

- Field slot slant is the primary read - if he wins inside ball comes out hot before Mike can react
- Boundary hitches create horizontal stress on outside LB - he can't cover both inside and outside shoulders
- Hitches sit at 5 yards in grass, don't drift forward or backward
- RB flat provides horizontal stretch and safety valve vs pressure

"2026 LUZERN SPACING



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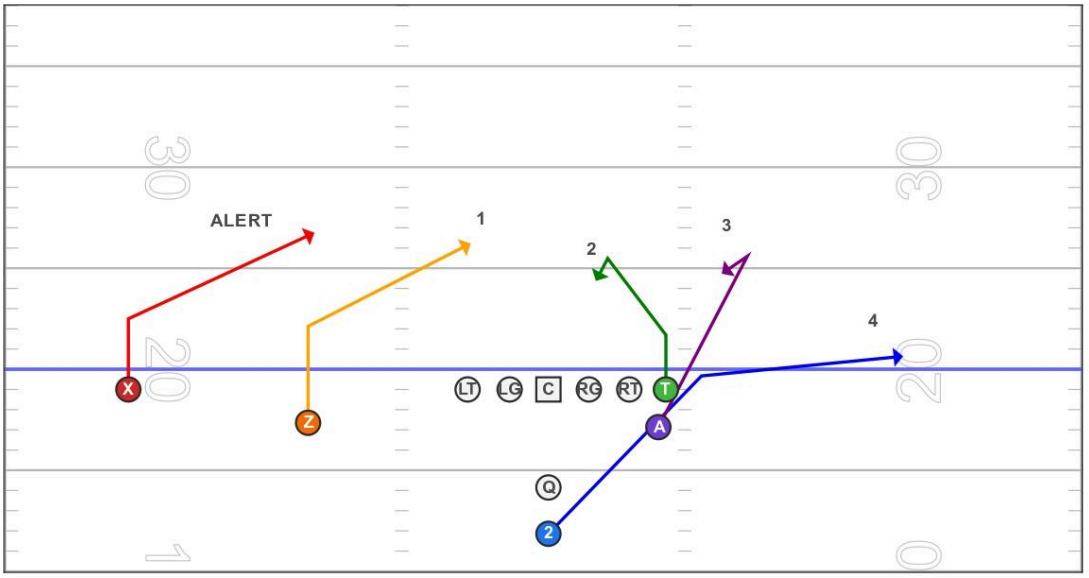

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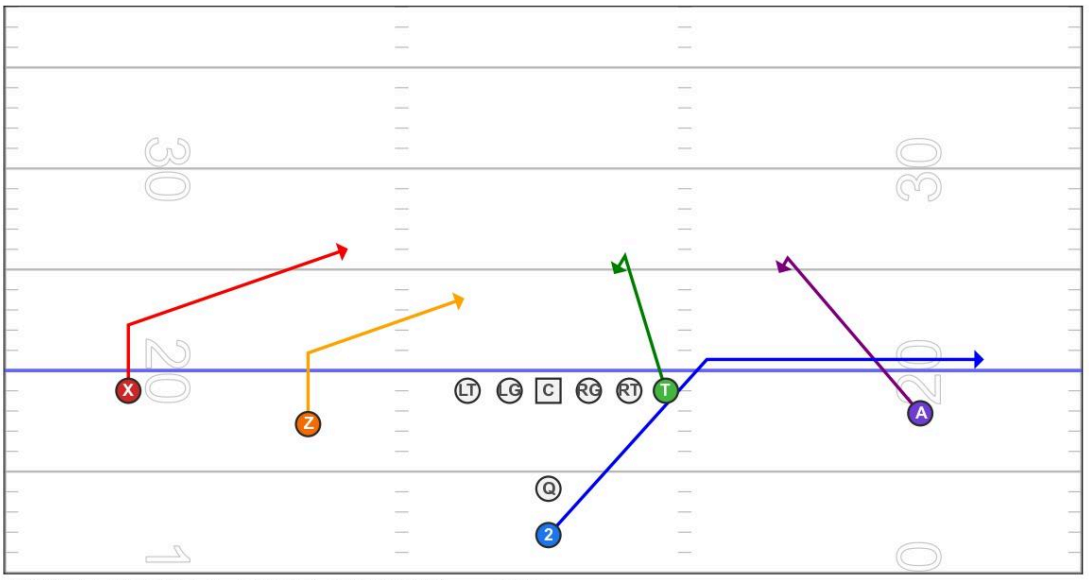

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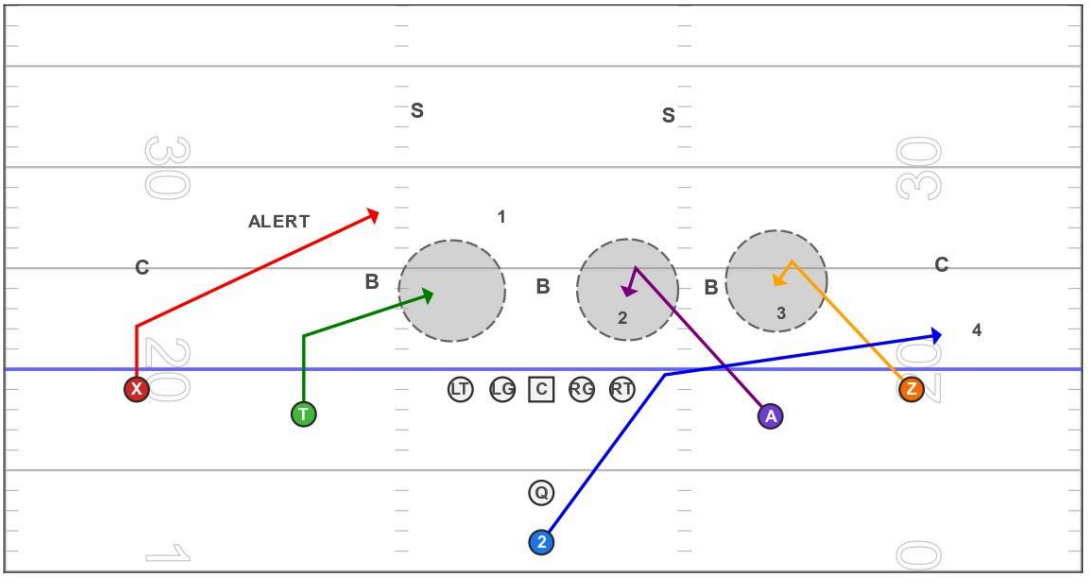


SMASH

Rules: Mirrored play. 2x2 Formation only.

2x2 Formation:

- **Both Sides (Field and Boundary):**
  - #1: HITCH route — 5 yards, sit in grass
  - #2: CORNER route — Push vertical, break to corner at 10-12 yards
  - 2-back**:** Hitch route — Check release, find grass in the middle

Stacked Formation Adjustment:

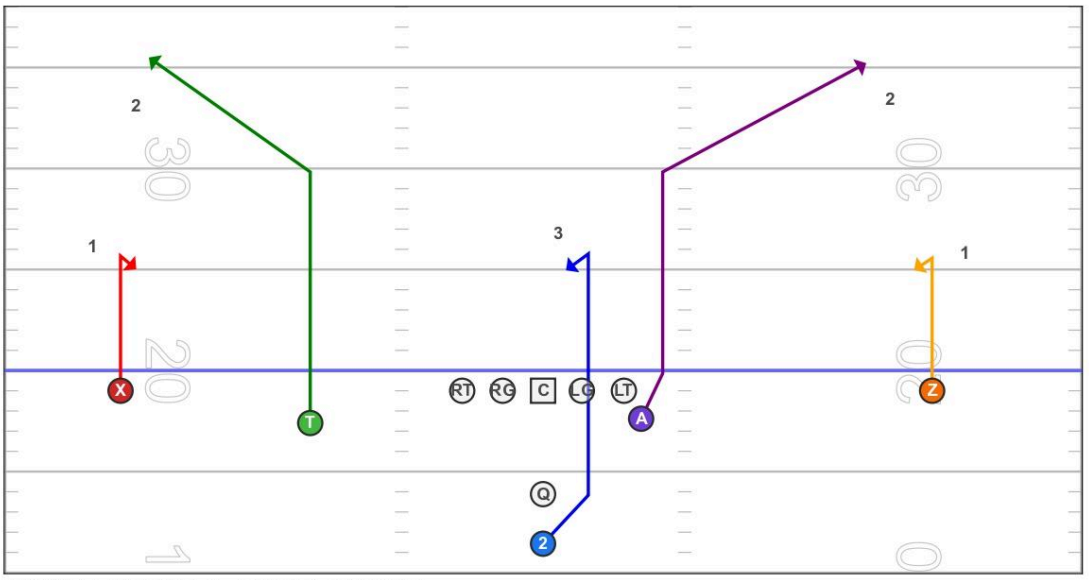
- **Stack Side:**
  - #1: CORNER route — Push vertical, break to corner at 10-12 yards
  - #2: 5-OUT route — 5 yards, out-breaking route

QB Progression: Pick a side pre-snap, read the cornerback → 1 (5-Out - low) → 2 (Corner - high) → CD (RB angle)

Key Coaching Points:

- High-low stretch on CB - if he sits on hitch/5-out, throw corner; if he backs up, throw hitch/5-out
- Hitch at 5 yards must be precise depth - sit in grass
- Corner route must threaten vertical before breaking outside at 10-12 yards
- QB picks side pre-snap based on safety leverage and CB alignment
- Work the CB - his movement tells you where to throw
- RB angle provides middle safety valve

"2026 LUZERN SMASH



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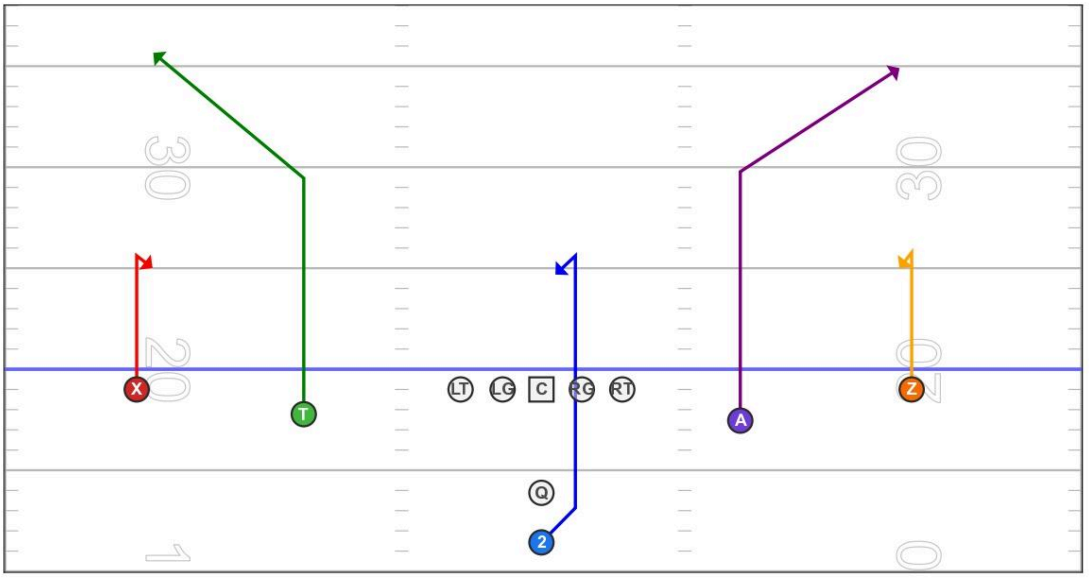

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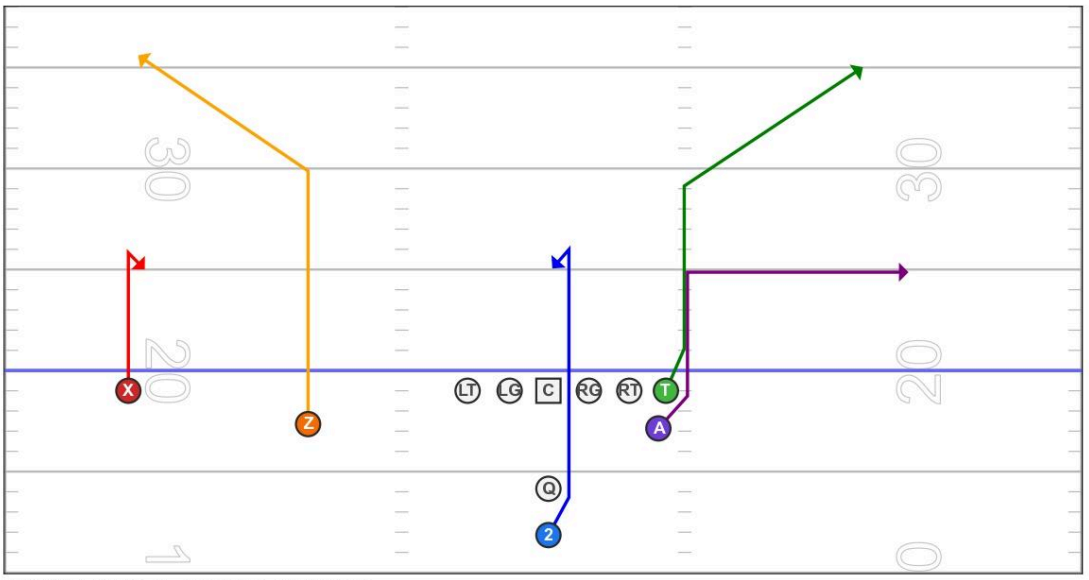

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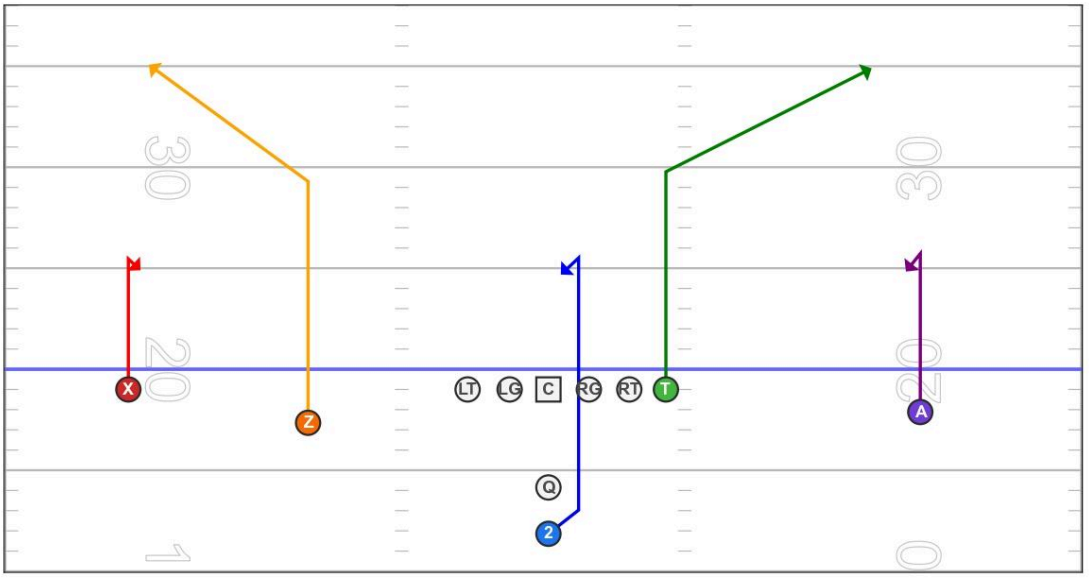


DROPBACK GAME

GLANCE

Rules: 2x2 Concept on BOUNDARY, **3x1** Concept on 3-RECEIVER side.

2x2 Formation:

- **Boundary (Concept Side):**
  - #1: GLANCE route — 10-12 yards, vertical release, win inside leverage vs CB, stay between safeties and linebackers, find the window
  - #2: WHEEL route — Win the outside, push vertical up sideline
  - RB: FLAT to boundary — 2-3 yard depth, horizontal stretch
- **Field (Backside):**
  - #1: HITCH route — 5 yards, sit in grass
  - #2: SLOT FADE — Win outside, attack over CB, push vertical

3x1 Formation:

- **Field (Concept Side - Trips):**
  - #1: GLANCE route — 10-12 yards, vertical release, win inside leverage vs CB, find window between safeties and linebackers
  - #2: WHEEL route — Win the outside, push vertical up sideline
  - #3: FLAT route — 2-3 yard depth, horizontal stretch
- **Boundary (Backside - Single):**
  - #1: HITCH route — 5 yards, sit in grass
  - 2-back: Pass Pro

QB Progression: 1 (Glance) → 2 (Wheel) → 3 (Flat) → Can work backside vs man/matchup

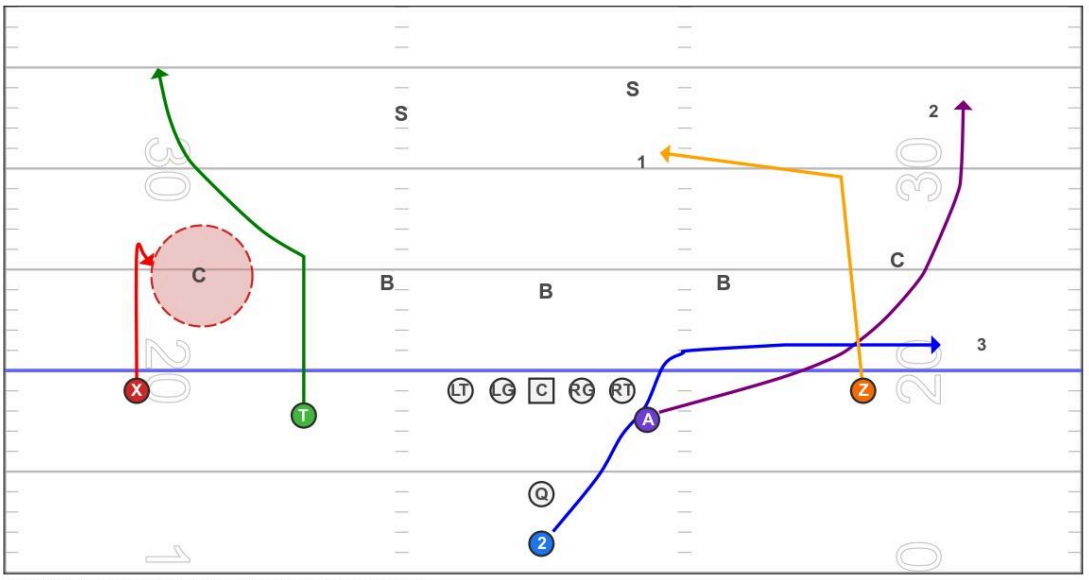
Tag Options:

GLANCE ARROW: Flat route will come from the other side of the field. 2back pass protection.

Key Coaching Points:

- Glance route must win inside leverage against CB on release - this is critical
- Find the window at 10-12 yards between levels - settle in grass
- Work high to low on concept side
- Backside routes are live vs man coverage or favorable matchups

"2026 LUZERN GLANCE vs OVER



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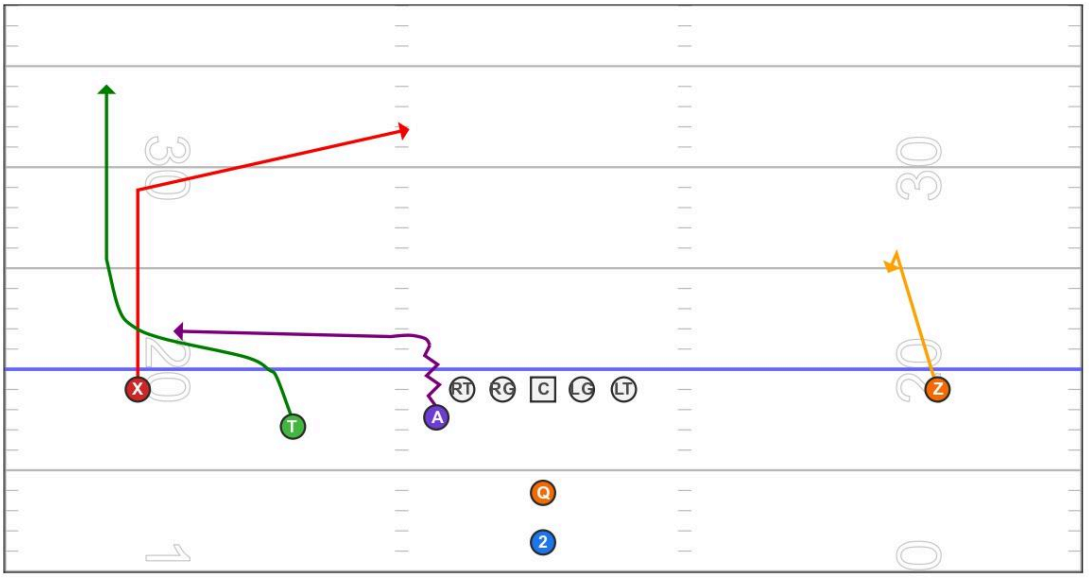

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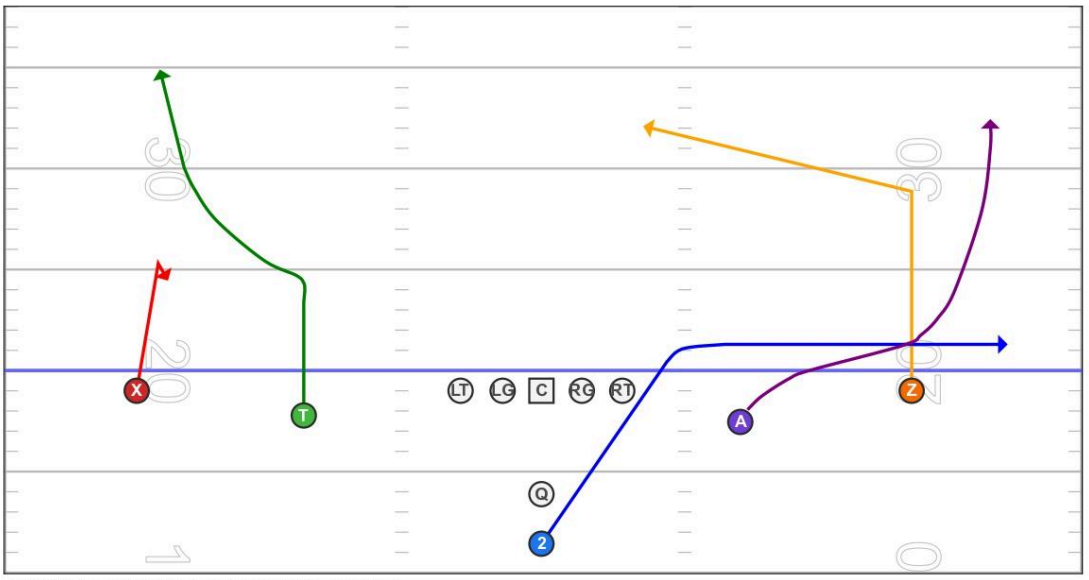
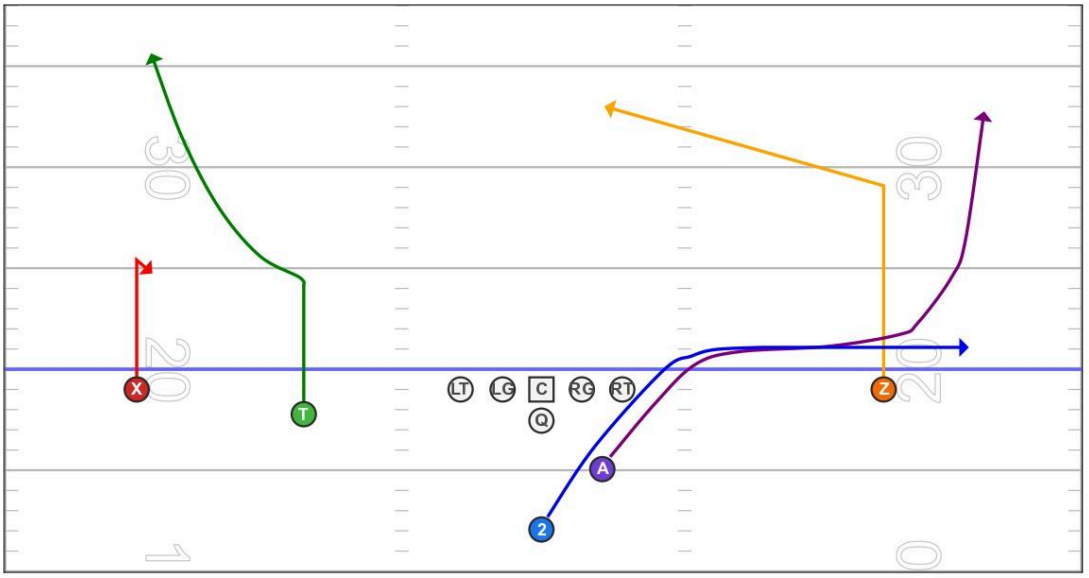


"2026 LUZERN I-OFF GLANCE



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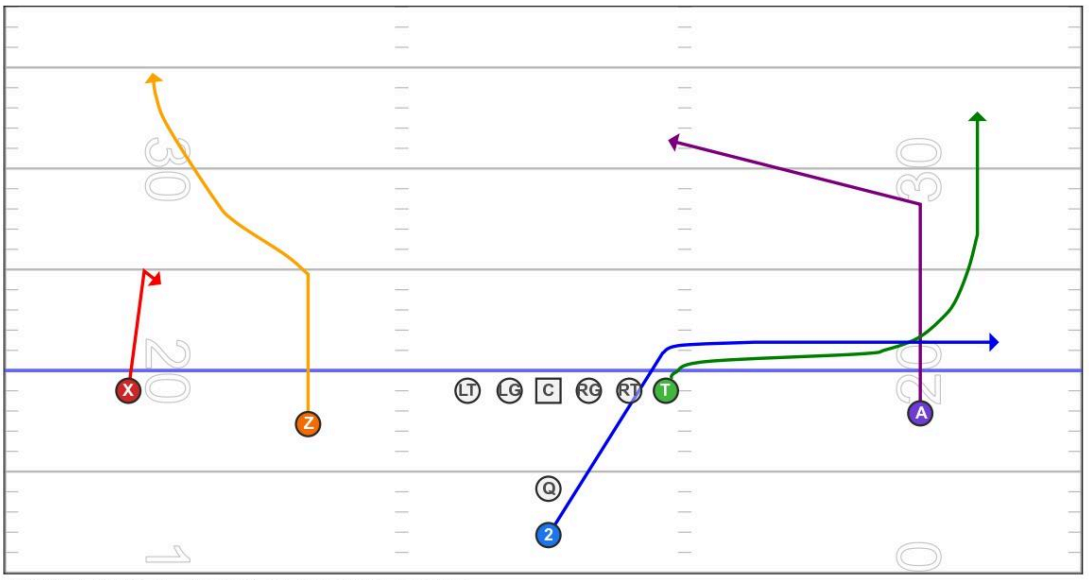

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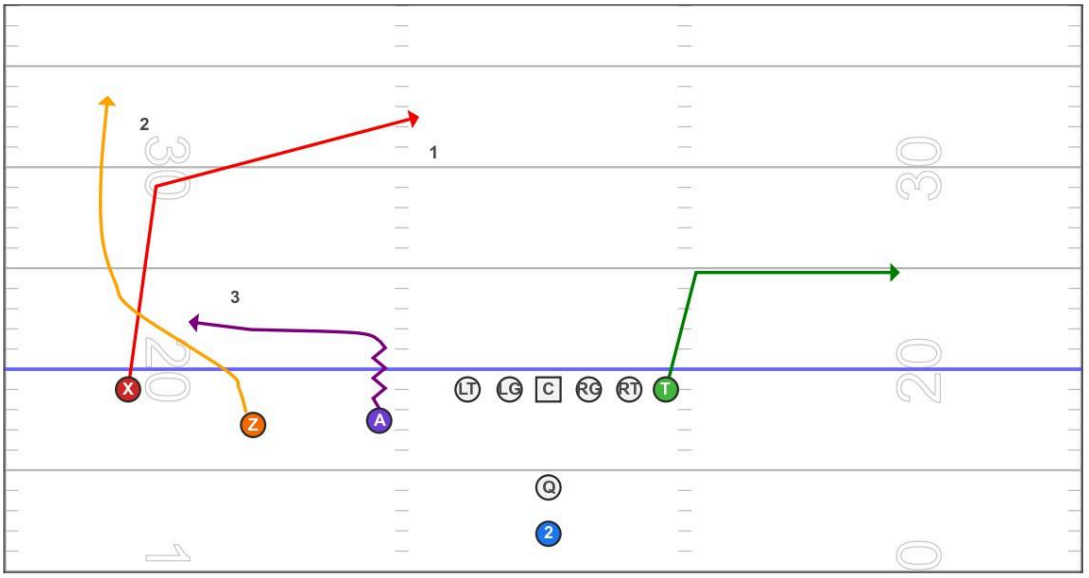
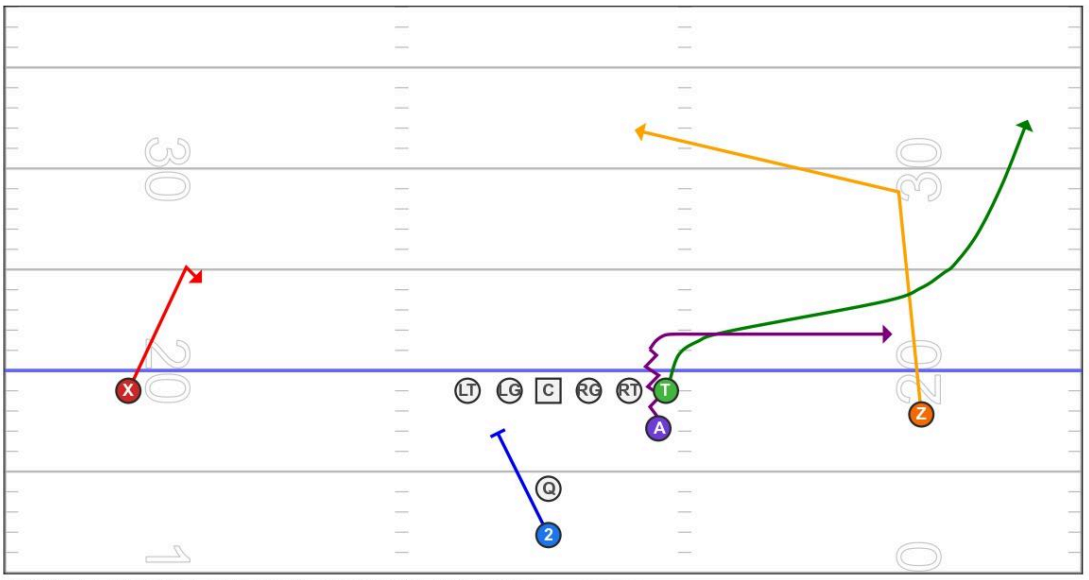
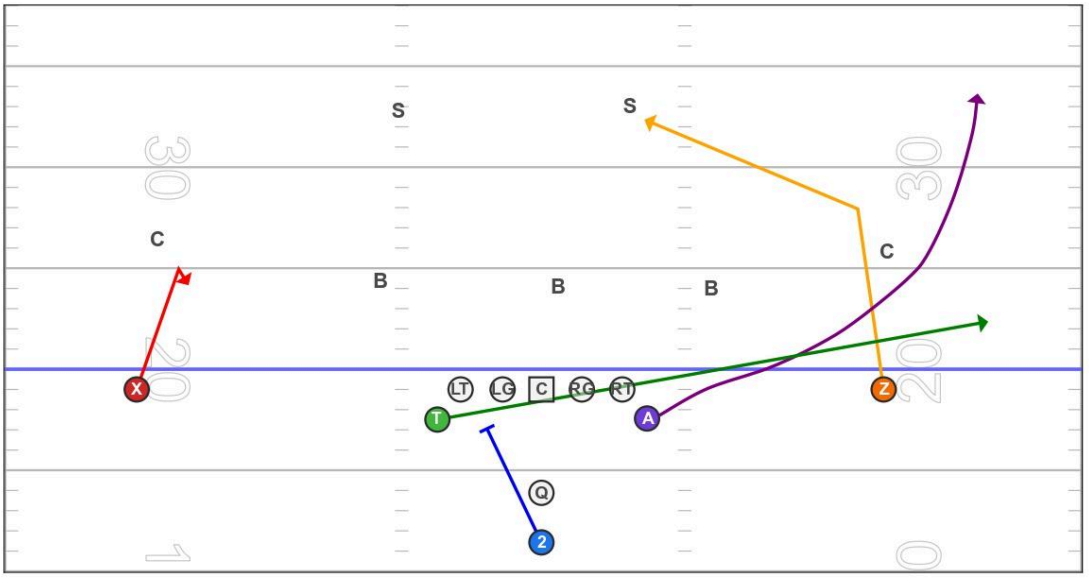


"2026 ZUG Z-FLIP GLANCE



"2026 LUZERN T-WING GLANCE ARROW vs OVER



[A-T] SHALLOW CROSS

Rules: 2x2 Formation only.

2x2 Formation:

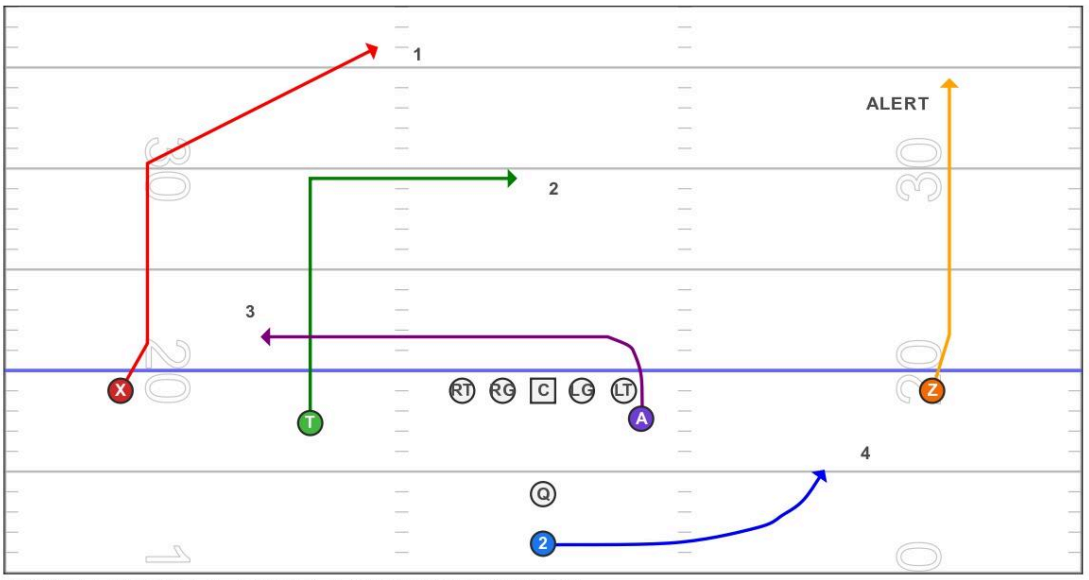
- **Field Side:**
  - #1: POST route — Win inside against CB, attack over Safety
  - #2: 10-YARD IN with breakdown — Around 10-12 yards, break down and sit in open window vs zone; continue vs man
- **Boundary Side:**
  - #1: GO route — 1-on-1 matchup, vertical clear (shot against favorable matchup)
  - #2: SHALLOW CROSS — Aim for d-line feet (1-2 yards deep), cross field to opposite flat zone
  - 2-back**:** SWING route to boundary

QB Progression: 1 (Post) → 2 (In) → 3 (Shallow cross) → CD (Swing), You can Alert 1on1 matchup on boundary.

Key Coaching Points:

- 3-step drop from gun - quick rhythm throw
- Shallow cross aims for d-line feet depth (1-2 yards) - stay low underneath coverage
- 10-yard in breaks down at 10-11 yards vs zone and sits in window - don't drift
- Post route attacks safety and clears space for underneath routes
- Boundary Go is a matchup shot - take it if you love it pre-snap
- RB swing provides width and checkdown option

"2026 LUZERN A SHALLOW CROSS



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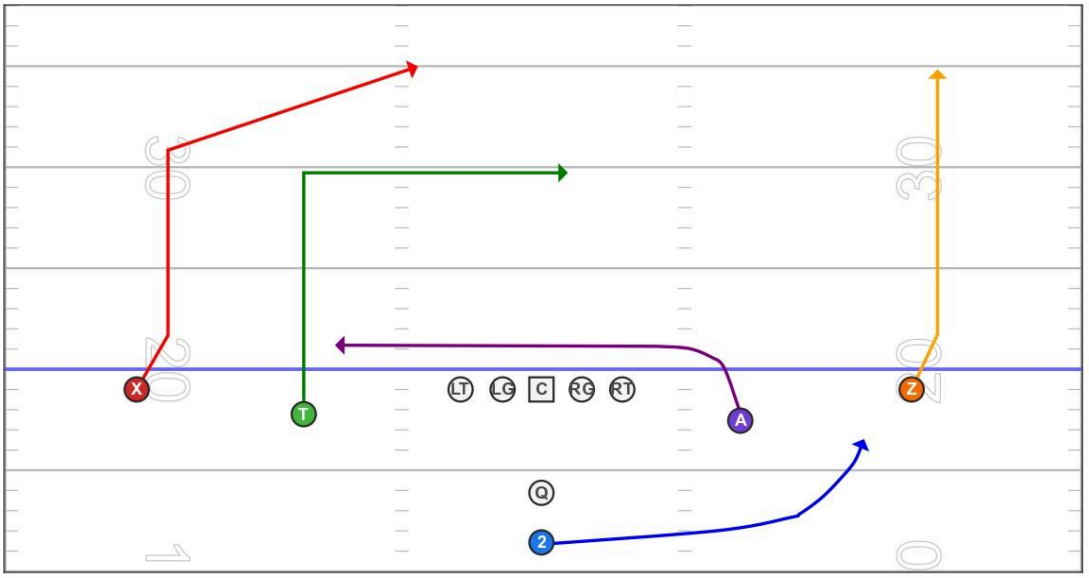

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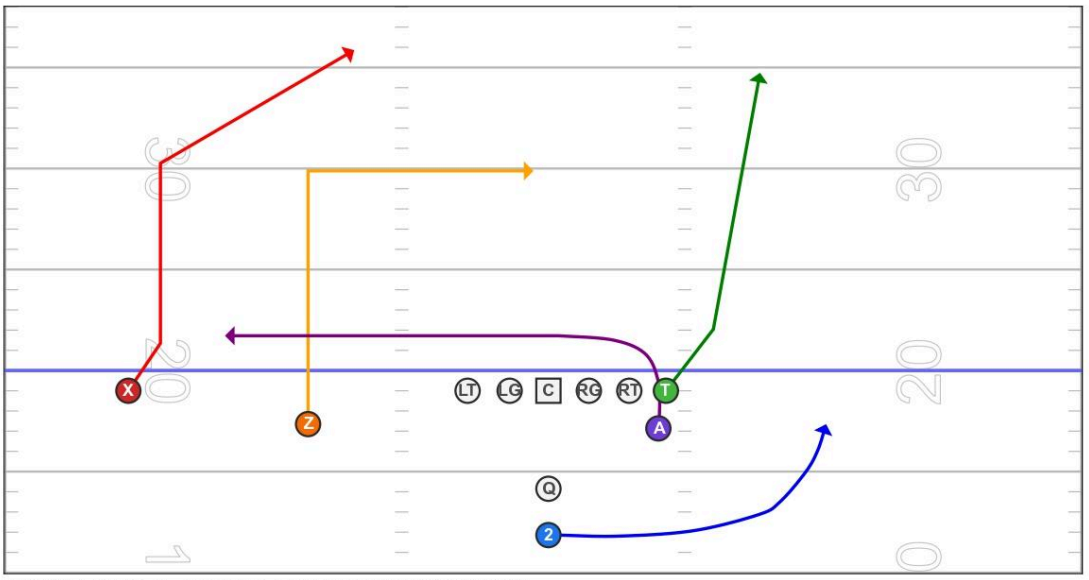

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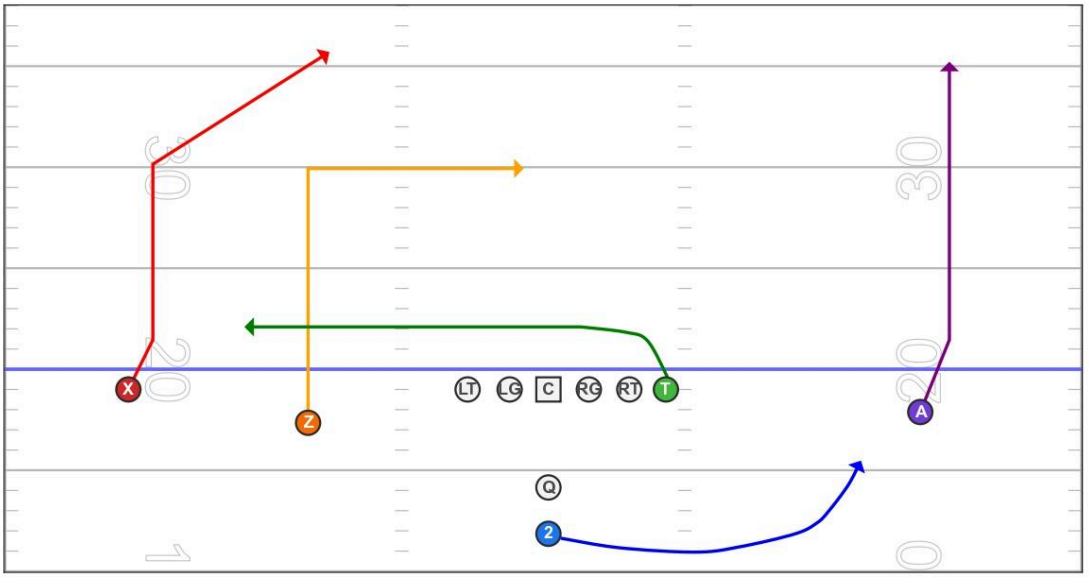

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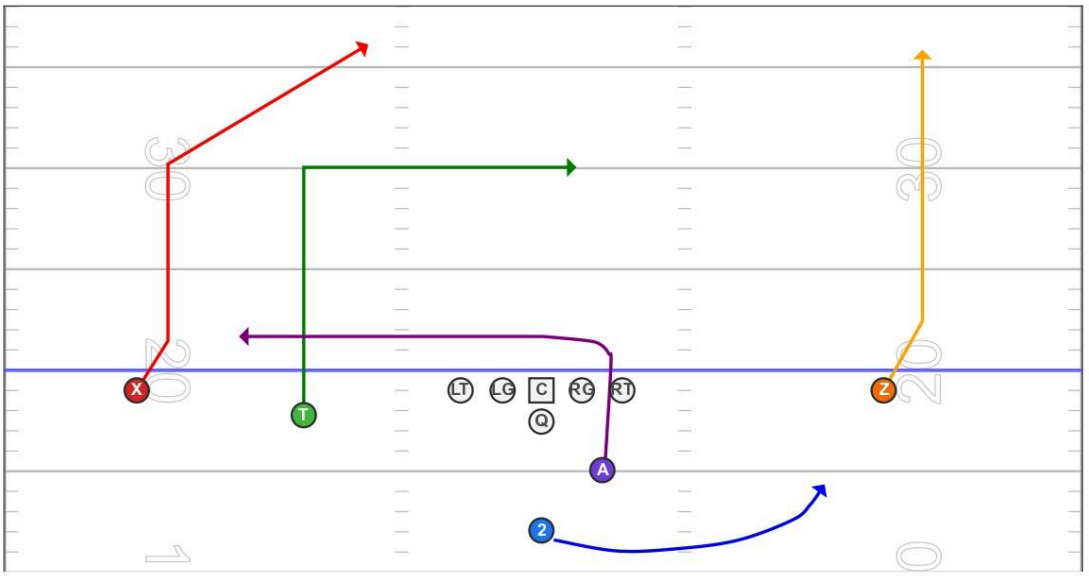

LT
LG
C
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RT
X
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MOSES

Rules: Mirrored concept in 2x2, deep cross added in 3x1.

2x2 Formation:

- **Both Sides (Field and Boundary):**
  - #1: COMEBACK route — Break at 14 yards, comeback to 12 yards
  - #2: SEAM route — Push vertical up seam, attack between CB and Safety
  - 2-back**:** Help pass protection

QB Progression: Pick side pre-snap based on safety and CB alignment → 1 (Seam) → 2 (Comeback)

3x1 Formation:

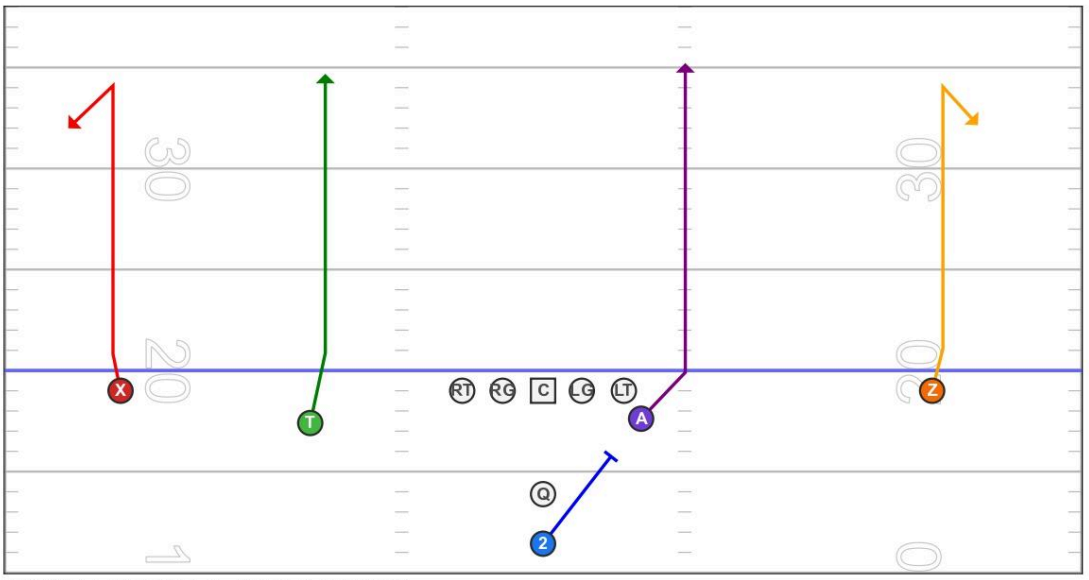
- **Trips Side (Field):**
  - #1: COMEBACK route — Break at 14 yards, comeback to 12 yards
  - #2: SEAM route — Push vertical up seam, attack between CB and Safety
  - #3: DEEP CROSS — Aim for 13-15 yards, attack middle of field to split safeties
- **Single Side (Boundary):**
  - #1: COMEBACK route — Break at 14 yards, comeback to 12 yards
  - 2-back**:** Help pass protection

QB Progression: 1 (Deep cross - #3) → 2 (Seam - #2) → 3 (Comebacks - trips or boundary based on coverage)

Key Coaching Points:

- Seam route attacks middle of field between CB and Safety - find the void
- Comeback stems vertical to 14 yards, breaks and comes back to 12 yards
- In 3x1, deep cross splits safeties at 13-15 yards and attacks middle
- In 2x2, QB picks side based on safety and CB pre-snap alignment
- Work inside to outside, high to low
- RB stays in for extra protection - this is a dropback concept that needs time

"2026 LUZERN MOSES



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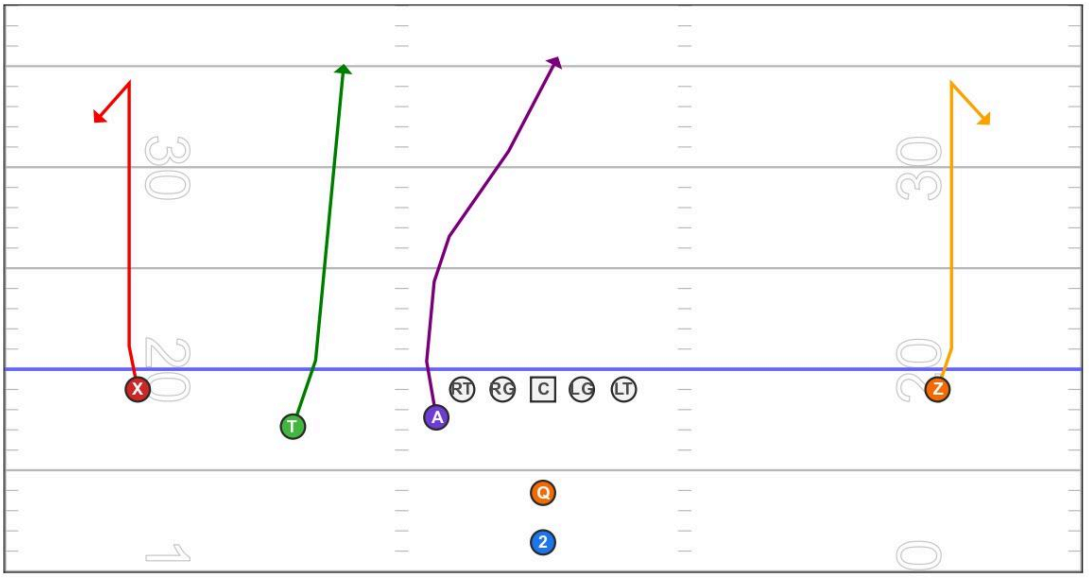

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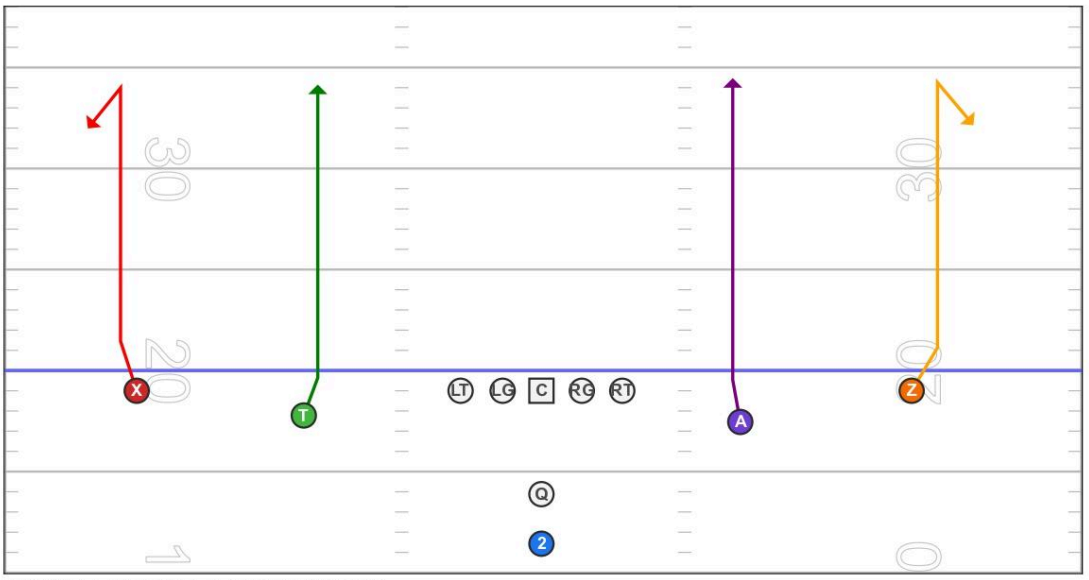

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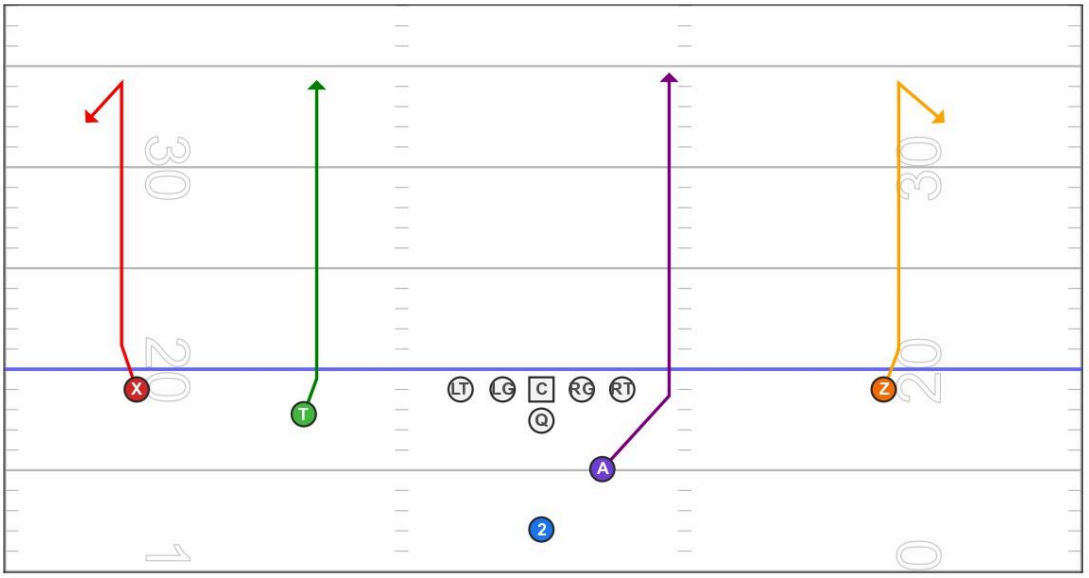

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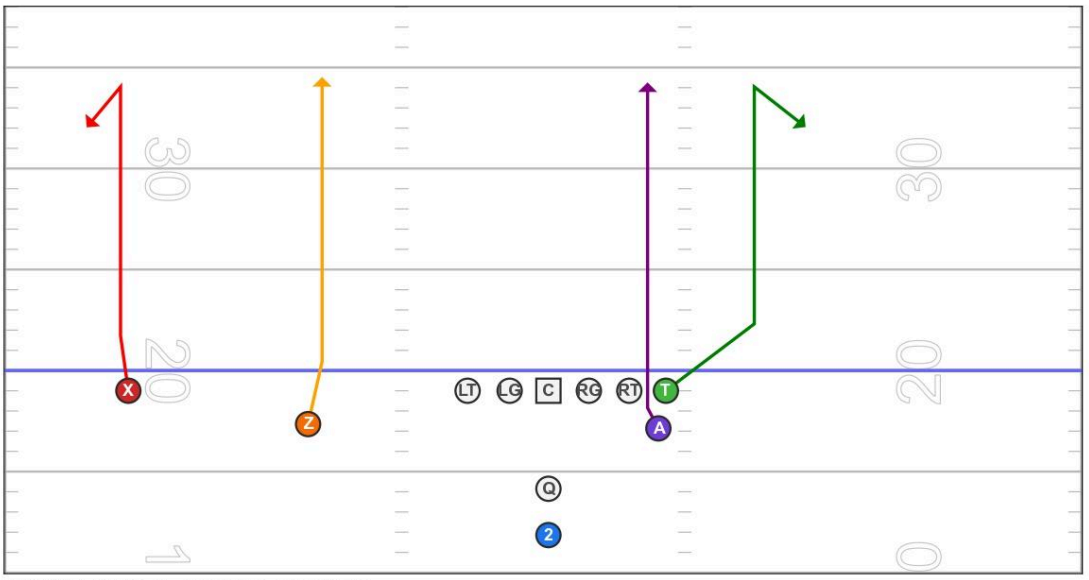

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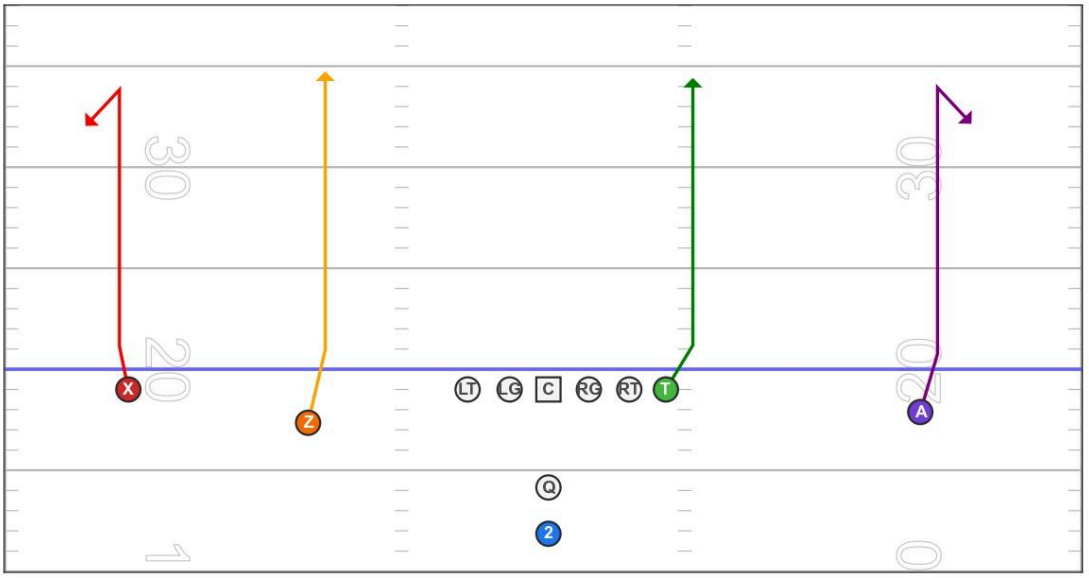

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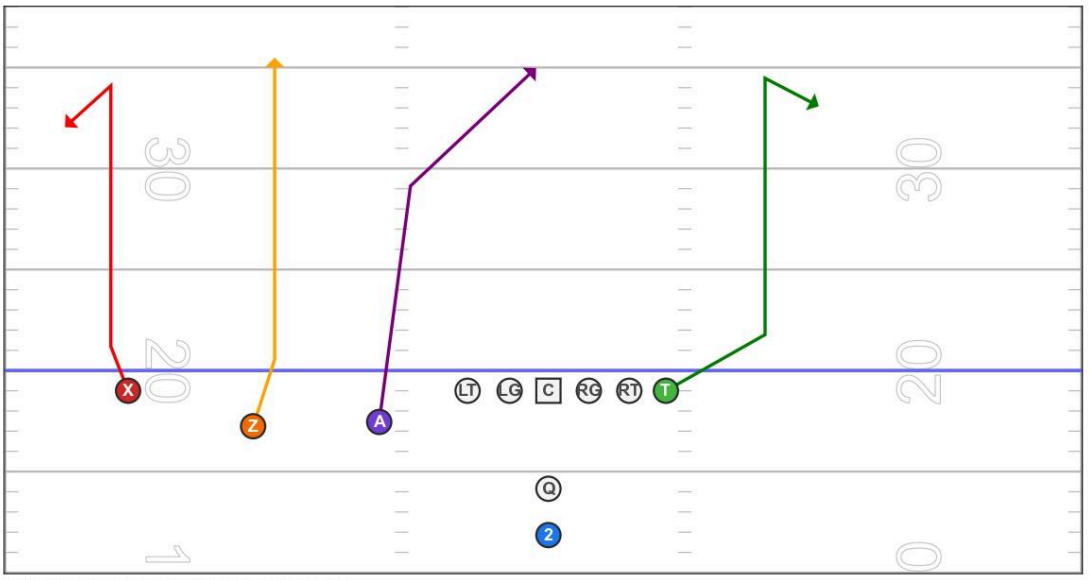

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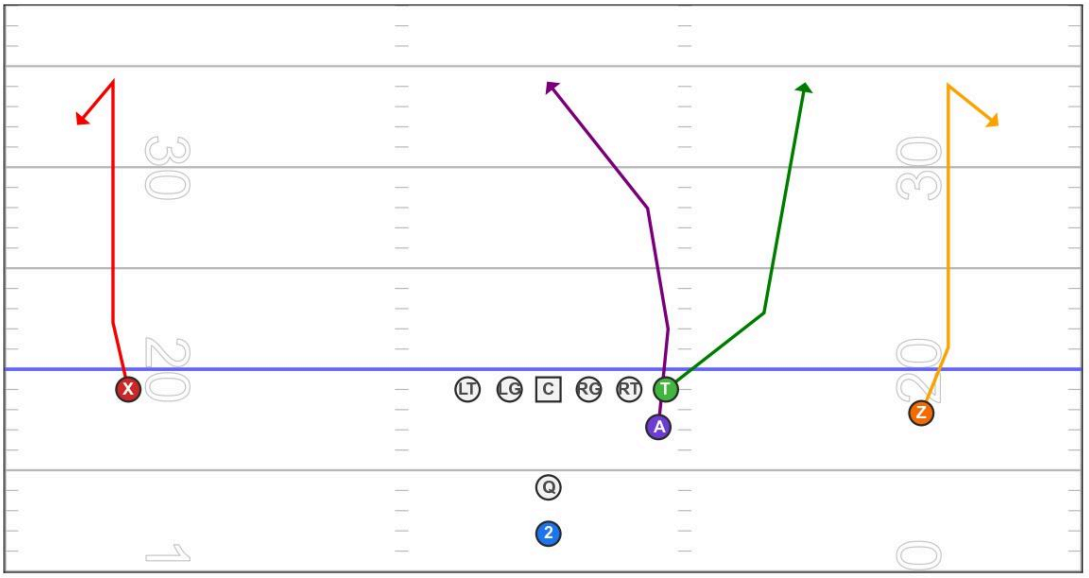


CROSS

Rules: Full field concept. **2x2** Concept flows to boundary**, 3x1** flows to single receiver side

2x2 Formation:

- **Boundary (Concept Side):**
  - #1: GO route — Must outside release, vertical clear
  - #2: 5-OUT route — 5 yards, out-breaking route
- **Field (Backside):**
  - #1: POST route — Aim for middle of the field, 15-18 yards
  - #2: CROSS route — Aim for 13-15 yards, cross hash toward boundary
  - 2-back**:** Pass protection

3x1 Formation:

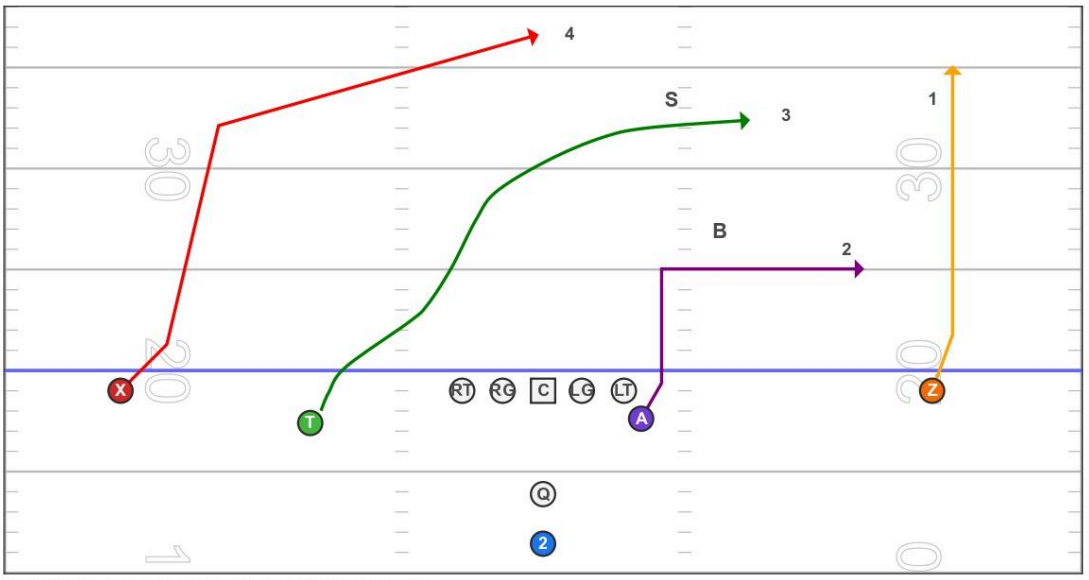
- **Single Side (Concept Side):**
  - #1: GO route — Must outside release, vertical clear
- **Trips Side (Backside):**
  - #1: POST route — Aim for middle of the field, 15-18 yards
  - #2: CROSS route — Aim for 13-15 yards, cross hash toward single side
  - #3: SHALLOW CROSS — Aim for d-line feet (1-2 yards), cross toward single side
  - 2-back**:** Pass protection. !! If it's undercenter, play-action

QB Progression: 1 (Go) → 2 (Shallow cross) → 3 (Cross) → 4 (Post) !! If it's undercenter, play-action

Key Coaching Points:

- Concept flows away from trips/field to create space for crossing routes
- Post and Cross create horizontal stretch at different levels
- All crossing routes flow toward the single receiver/boundary side
- Go route clears vertical space on concept side
- Work outside to inside, low to high through progressions
- RB stays in for protection - this concept needs time to develop

"2026 LUZERN T CROSS



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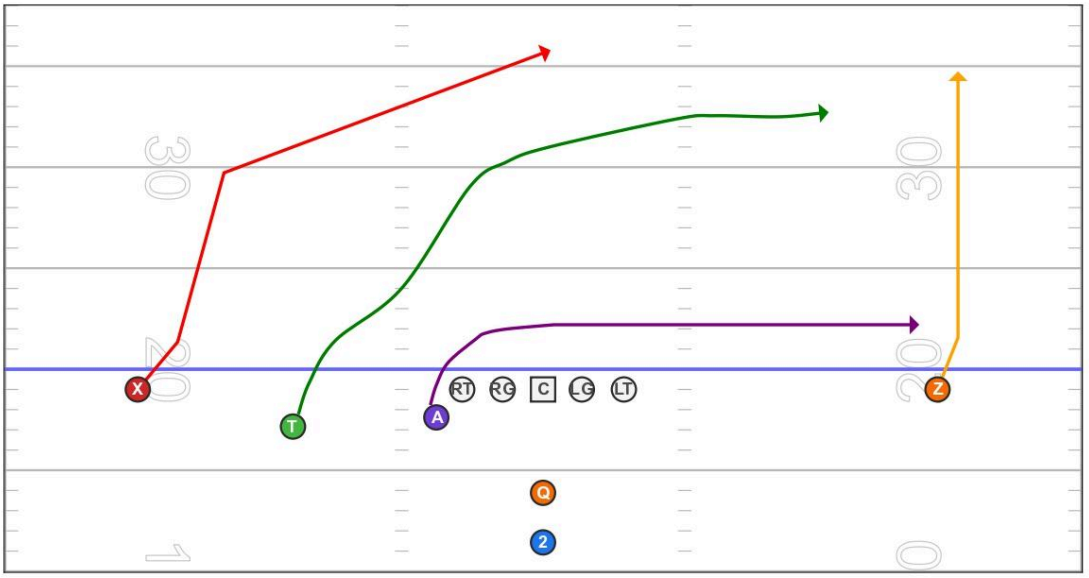

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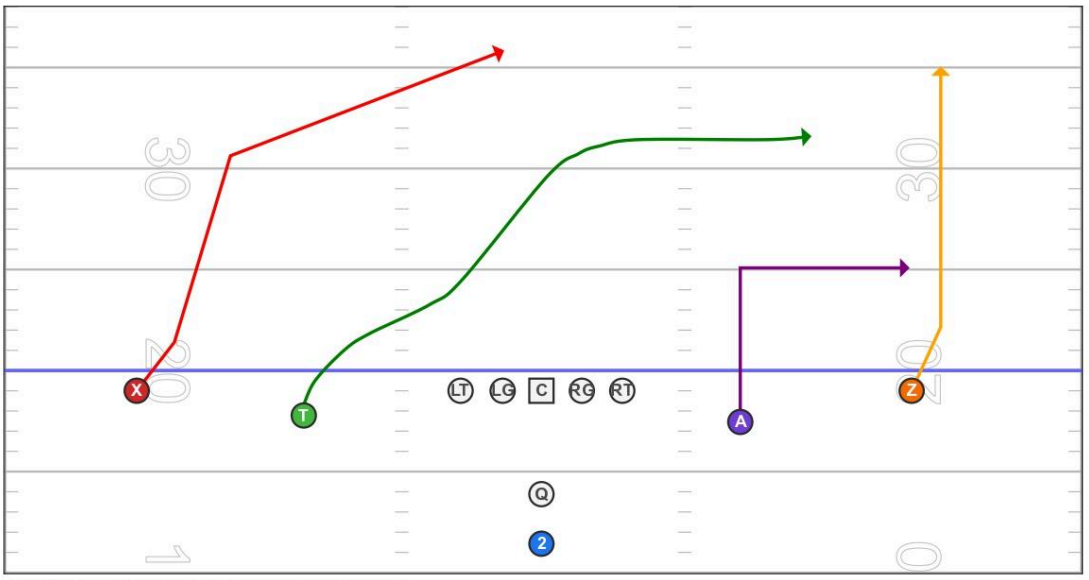

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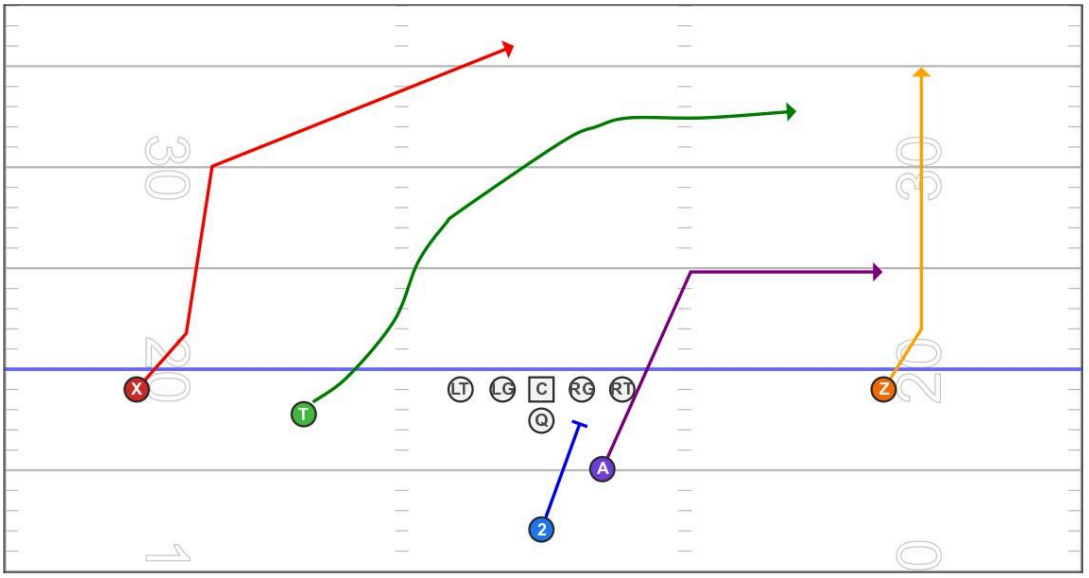

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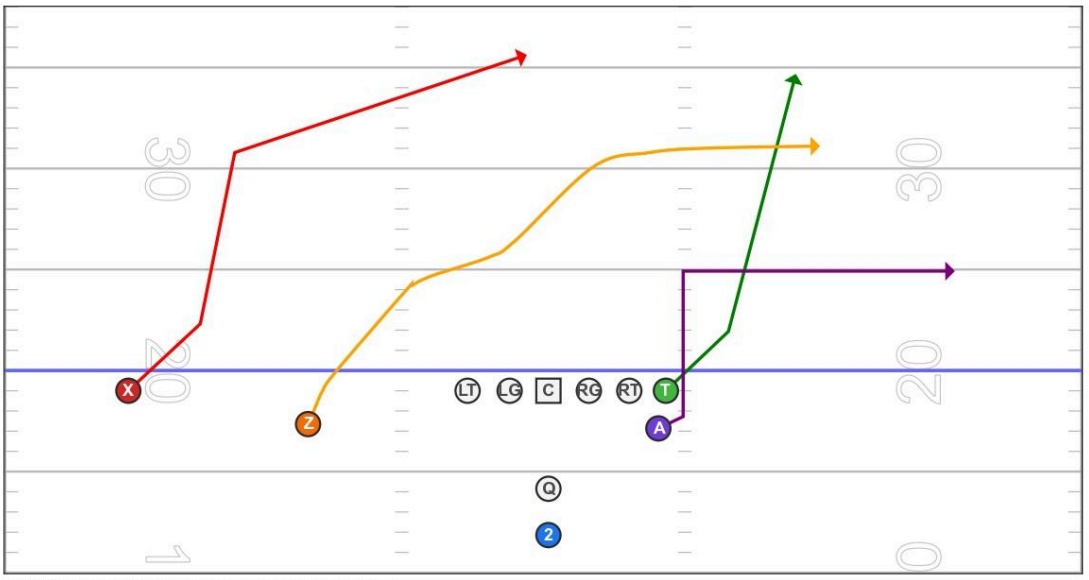

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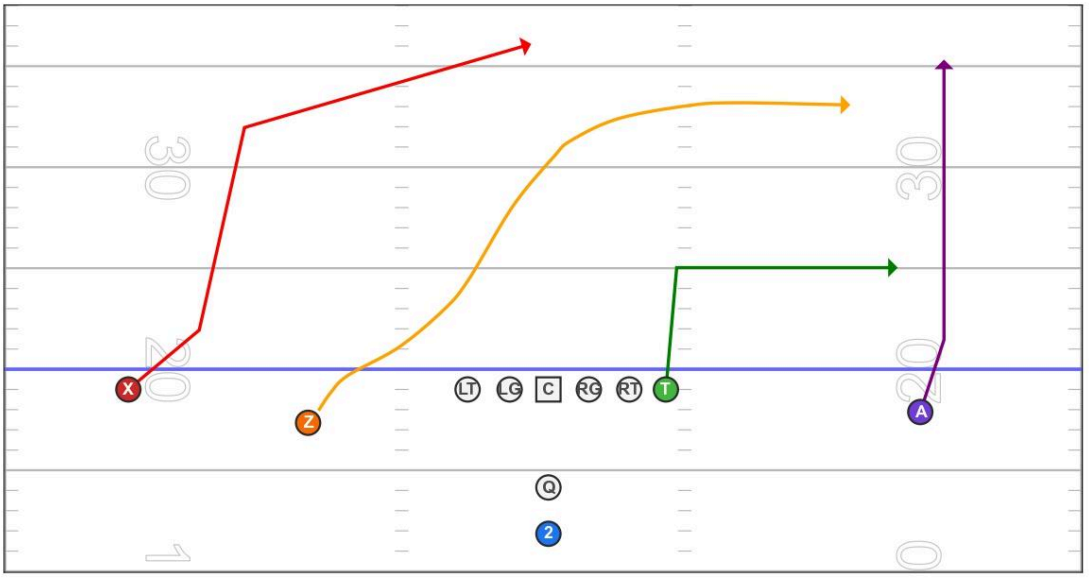

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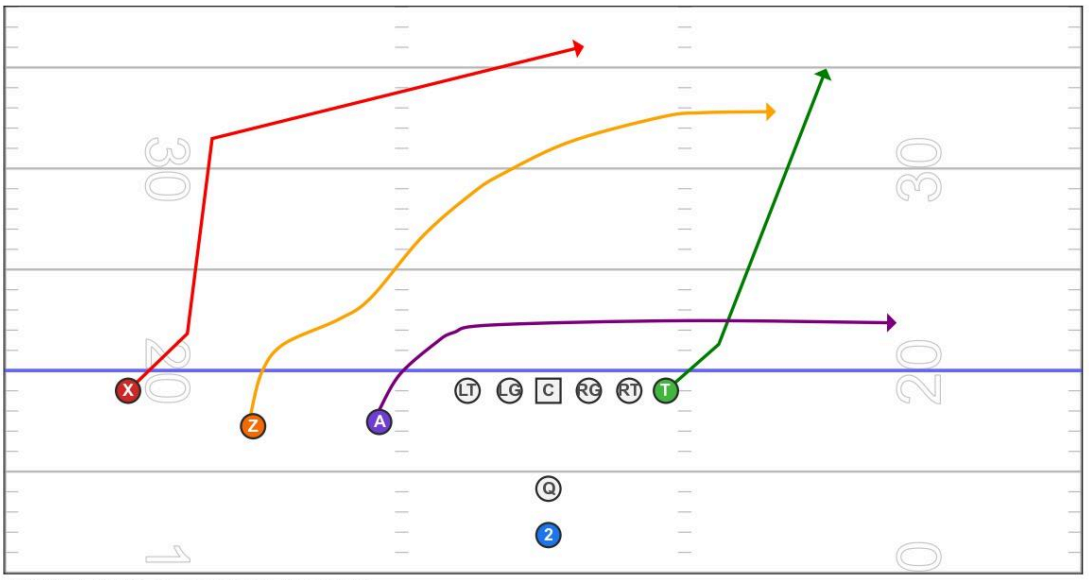
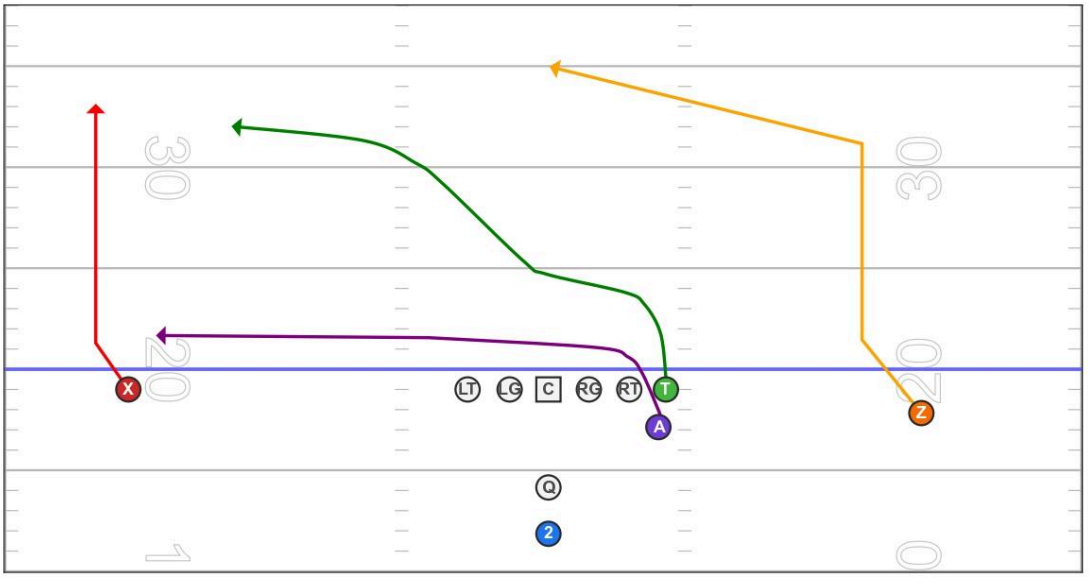
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